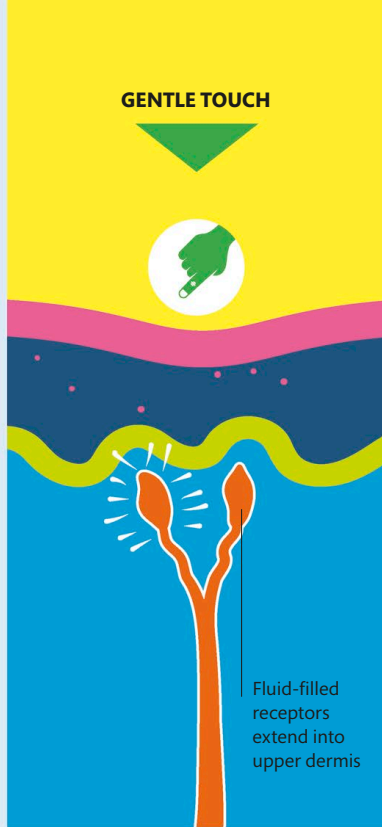
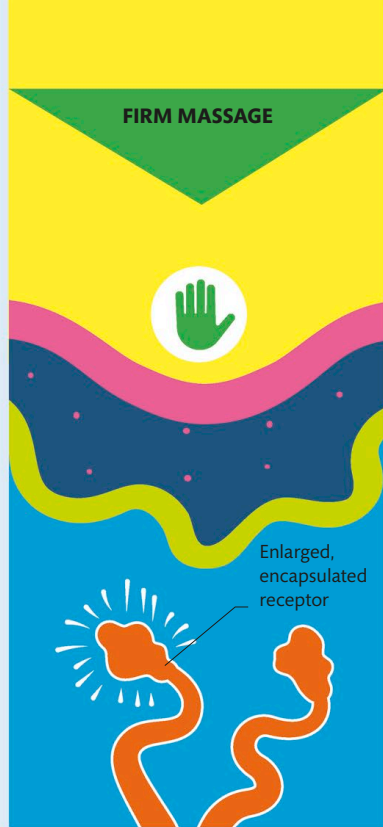




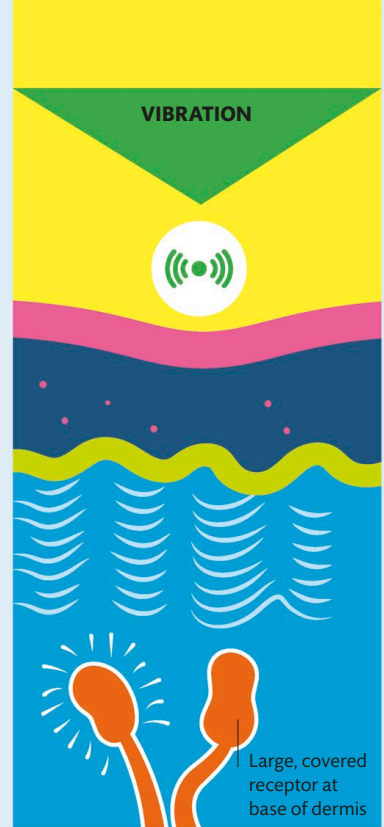
Meissner corpuscles

These receptors are rapidly adapting, meaning that they respond quickly to stimulation but stop firing if the stimulus continues. This gives precise information.



Ruffini endings

Also known as bulbous corpuscles, these soft, capsulelike cells—located deep in the dermis—respond if the skin or joints are stretched or distorted by pressure.



Pacinian corpuscle

The deepest and largest type of touch receptor, these rapidly acting mechanoreceptors respond to sustained pressure as well as vibration.

The somatosensory cortex

All information from touch receptors is processed in the somatosensory cortex. This area sits across the top of the brain like a hair band. Data from the right side of the body travels to the left side of the brain, and vice versa. Each part of the body maps to its own area of the cortex.

Touch map

Areas of the body rich in touch receptors, such as the hands, require more processing than others, so they take up a greater proportion of the somatosensory cortex.

